APEX FORGE

# WEBSITE AUDIT

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Hobson Plumbing & Heating, Inc. · hobsonplumbing.com · Audited 2026-10-07

*Measured, not asserted.*

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**Prepared for: Hobson Plumbing & Heating, Inc. · hobsonplumbing.com · Audited 2026-10-07**

*Measured, not asserted. Every number below traces to a live measurement taken on the audit date.*

*If this audit doesn't deliver, you get a full refund -- no questions, no forms.*

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## YOUR SCORE: 65/100 -- Grade C (Needs work)

| Category | Score | Weight | What it means in one line |
|---|---|---|---|
| Speed | 50/100 | 25 | Server takes 2.1 seconds just to answer; 17 blocking scripts pile on. |
| Mobile | 50/100 | 20 | Viewport is set -- but there is no tap-to-call link anywhere on the homepage. |
| SEO basics | 63/100 | 20 | Good title and meta, but two H1s and no LocalBusiness schema. |
| Contact path | 75/100 | 15 | Full quote form right on the homepage -- but no response promise and no hours listed. |
| Reviews | 100/100 | 10 | 5.0* across 32 reviews; testimonials on the site. |
| Trust signals | 83/100 | 10 | License #058-179219 stated; social profiles linked; footer copyright says 2019. |

**In plain English:** You have the trust (5-star reviews, a license number, a real quote form on the homepage) but the site is actively leaking the mobile callers who matter most: it answers slowly, and a person on their phone literally cannot tap to call you. Those two fixes alone would move this score more than anything else on the list.

# THE 3 THINGS COSTING YOU THE MOST

- **[CRITICAL] 2.1-second server answer** -- measured 2,099ms time-to-first-byte on 2026-10-07, against a 600ms bar. A caller on a phone may stare at a blank screen before your number appears.
- **[CRITICAL] No tap-to-call on the homepage** -- zero `tel:` links found in the homepage HTML (2026-10-07). Your customers call from phones; you're making them memorize or copy-paste the number.
- **[MAJOR] 17 render-blocking scripts + 9 blocking stylesheets** -- counted in the homepage HTML (2026-10-07). Each one delays the moment the page becomes usable.

# FULL FINDINGS (ranked by revenue impact)

## 1. Server takes 2.1 seconds to answer -- CRITICAL

- **Measured:** 2,099ms time-to-first-byte, GET homepage (2026-10-07). Bar: <600ms pass, >=1,500ms major.
- **Why it costs you:** Everything else waits on the server's first byte. On mobile this is the difference between a caller and a bounce.
- **Fix:** Server/page caching (the site runs WordPress -- a caching plugin + PHP OPcache), consider a CDN.
- **Effort:** Needs a developer or a good host, ~2-4 hours.

## 2. No tap-to-call link anywhere on the homepage -- CRITICAL

- **Measured:** Zero `tel:` links in homepage HTML (2026-10-07). The number 630-761-3400 appears as plain text in the header.
- **Why it costs you:** Home-service customers call from phones. A tap-to-call button is the single highest-converting element on a plumber's mobile site, and yours is missing.
- **Fix:** Wrap the header phone number in `<a href="tel:6307613400">` and add a sticky "Call Now" button on mobile.
- **Effort:** 30 minutes.

## 3. 17 blocking scripts + 9 blocking stylesheets -- MAJOR

- **Measured:** HTML parse of homepage (2026-10-07): 17 synchronous `<script src>` tags, 9 render-blocking stylesheets.
- **Why it costs you:** Each blocks the browser from showing content. Combined with the slow server answer, the page feels broken on phones.
- **Fix:** Add `defer`/`async` to non-critical scripts, consolidate stylesheets, remove unused plugins.
- **Effort:** Needs a developer, ~2-3 hours.

## 4. Two H1 tags, no LocalBusiness schema -- MAJOR

- **Measured:** 2 `<h1>` elements on the homepage; zero JSON-LD schema blocks (2026-10-07).
- **Why it costs you:** Search engines use the H1 and LocalBusiness schema to understand you're a North Aurora plumber. Competitors with clean markup rank more reliably.
- **Fix:** Keep one H1, demote the other to H2; add LocalBusiness JSON-LD with name, address, phone, hours.
- **Effort:** ~1 hour.

## 5. No response-time promise, no hours on the homepage -- MAJOR

- **Measured:** Full homepage copy review (2026-10-07): no "respond within X" promise; footer lists 16 service towns but no business hours.
- **Why it costs you:** A burst pipe is an emergency. Callers pick the company that promises speed and shows it's open.
- **Fix:** Add hours to the footer and one promise line near the phone: "Call now -- we answer 7:30AM-4PM, Mon-Fri." (Only promise what you keep.)
- **Effort:** 20 minutes.

## 6. Google Business Profile not linked from the site -- MINOR

- **Measured:** No outbound link to Google Maps/GBP found on the homepage (2026-10-07), though a listing with your 5.0*/32 reviews exists.
- **Why it costs you:** A "Find us on Google" link turns site visitors into reviewers and reinforces the listing.
- **Fix:** Link your Google Business Profile from the footer/contact page.
- **Effort:** 10 minutes.

## 7. Footer copyright says 2019 -- MINOR

- **Measured:** "(c) 2019 Hobson Plumbing & Heating" in the footer (2026-10-07).
- **Why it costs you:** A stale date whispers "nobody maintains this site" to exactly the detail-oriented customers you want.
- **Fix:** Update to (c) 2026 (or make it automatic).
- **Effort:** 5 minutes.

**What passed:** The quote form is excellent -- full contact form (name, email, mobile, address) right on the homepage, one step from landing to "send." Title (53 chars) and meta description (153 chars) are textbook. Sitemap + robots present. Clear CTA on all 5 top pages crawled. 5.0*/32 reviews with on-site testimonials. License #058-179219 stated in the footer. Social profiles (Facebook, Instagram, Twitter) linked. Zero broken links found on 8 homepage links. Page weight is light (~358KB measured).

**Not measured:** LCP, CLS, Total Blocking Time (need a browser render -- excluded, not estimated). Tap-target sizes, mobile-menu taps, form usability on a real phone render. Review recency and owner review responses (not verifiable from public snippets). Origin TLS certificate details (sandbox routes through a proxy; the site serves HTTPS with no mixed content). Third NAP source for street address (not in homepage footer).

# WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

**Option 1 -- Fix it yourself.** Everything above is yours to keep, with or without us. The ranked list is the roadmap.

**Option 2 -- We fix the top 5 for you.** Quoted per project in the $500-$1,500 range, on Brandon's tap before any number ships. Covers fixes 1-5 above, done-for-you.

**Option 3 -- The Deep Audit ($297, your $75 credited).** Competitor head-to-head against the other Aurora/North Aurora plumbers, full conversion teardown, and a 30-minute recorded walkthrough of these findings.

**Site Care ($97/mo, cancel anytime):** we watch your site 24/7 -- uptime, speed, broken links, certificate expiry -- and send you one plain-English health report a month.

*Questions? Reply to this email -- it reaches Brandon directly.*

*Apex Forge · Refund guarantee: full refund if this audit doesn't deliver. Just say the word.*

*Evidence pack: `evidence/hobson-plumbing-heating-evidence.json` (all measurements, methods, timestamps).*